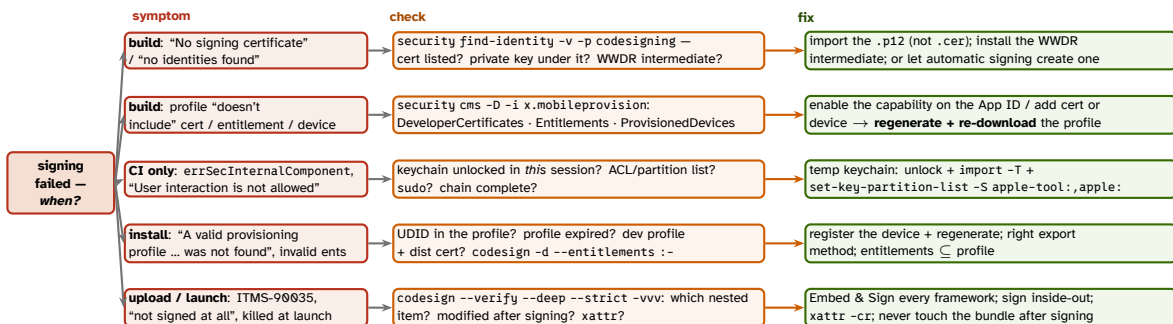


In one line: Every signing error is a **mismatch between four things** that must agree — the **identity** (certificate + *private key* in a reachable keychain), the **profile** (App ID, certificates, entitlements, devices, expiry), the **signed entitlements** and the **bundle** (every nested binary signed, nothing changed after). First ask *when* it fails — build, CI only, install, upload, launch — then **decode both sides and diff them** instead of toggling Xcode settings.



Message (abridged)	Real cause	Fix
No signing certificate “Apple Distribution” found	identity not in a searched keychain, or the cert is there <i>without</i> its private key	import the .p12 from the Mac that made the CSR (or match); revoking + recreating breaks other machines
Provisioning profile “X” doesn’t include the aps-environment entitlement ... doesn’t include signing certificate “Apple Development: Alice (...)” profile / cert from another team	capability in .entitlements but not enabled on the App ID, or the profile predates it profile lists other certs (new Mac, cert renewed)	enable on the App ID → regenerate profile → download (automatic signing does all three) regenerate the profile with your cert selected
certificate expired or revoked	DEVELOPMENT_TEAM ≠ profile’s TeamIdentifier (often an extension target) 1-year Development/Distribution cert ran out, or a teammate revoked it	one team per target set; check every target new cert → new profiles; App Store builds already live are unaffected
A valid provisioning profile for this executable was not found resource fork, Finder information, or similar detritus not allowed code object is not signed at all — In subcomponent: .../Frameworks/X.framework ITMS-90035 Invalid Signature	at install: expired profile, device missing, or profile/cert mismatch extended attributes on files in the bundle (iCloud Drive / Dropbox folder, downloaded assets) nested binary unsigned: “Embed Without Signing”, a Mach-O in Resources/, a patched vendor binary dev/ad hoc identity, sealed resource missing/invalid, odd filenames, script files in the bundle	decode embedded.mobileprovision inside the .ipa and compare xattr -cr App.app, build outside synced folders Embed & Sign; put code where code goes; re-sign inside-out
ITMS-90164 / ITMS-90046	signed entitlements not all in the profile / not valid on iOS (wildcard associated domain, malformed application-identifier)	distribution identity, Release config, clean build, rename files diff codesign -d --entitlements vs the profile; explicit values only
unsupported architectures [x86_64, i386] (ITMS-90087 (unverified))	simulator slices in a fat vendor framework	ship an .xcframework, or strip before signing

Example — decode both sides and diff

```

unzip -q App.ipa && APP=Payload/App.app
security cms -D -i $APP/embedded.mobileprovision > prof.plist
/usr/libexec/PlistBuddy -c 'Print :Entitlements' prof.plist # allowed
/usr/libexec/PlistBuddy -c 'Print :ProvisionedDevices' prof.plist
codesign -d --entitlements :- $APP # actually signed
codesign -dvvv $APP 2>&1 | grep -E 'Authority|TeamIdentifier'
security find-identity -v -p codesigning # SHA-1 of your certs
xcodebuild -showBuildSettings | grep -E 'CODE_SIGN|PROVISIONING|TEAM'
codesign --verify --deep --strict -vvv $APP # nested damage
    
```

Where things live

- Profiles: **Xcode 16+**
~/Library/Developer/Xcode/UserData/Provisioning Profiles; Xcode ≤ 15
~/Library/MobileDevice/Provisioning Profiles — tools and CI scripts hard-coding the old path need updating.
- In the product: embedded.mobileprovision (iOS), embedded.provisionprofile (macOS). Keys: TeamIdentifier, Entitlements, DeveloperCertificates, ProvisionedDevices, ExpirationDate.

Automatic vs manual signing

- Automatic** (CODE_SIGN_STYLE = Automatic): Xcode creates certs, App IDs, “Xcode Managed” profiles, registers the connected device. On CI: xcodebuild -allowProvisioningUpdates + an App Store Connect API key (-authenticationKey{Path, ID, IssuerID}).
- Manual:** CODE_SIGN_IDENTITY + PROVISIONING_PROFILE_SPECIFIER per target; deterministic — usual on CI with match.

- Every target signs separately:** each app extension / watch app has its own App ID and profile; the host’s profile does not cover them.

On the device

- iOS 16+: development-signed apps need **Developer Mode** (Settings > Privacy & Security); TestFlight / App Store builds don’t.
- Enterprise builds: the user must trust the developer (Settings > General > VPN & Device Management) and the first launch verifies online (unverified).
- No debugger on a distribution build: no get-task-allow.

Traps

- ! “Revoke and recreate the certificate” — kills every other machine’s key and CI; export the .p12 instead.
- ! Capability works in Debug, fails in Release: only the *development* profile was regenerated.
- ! Toggling “Automatically manage signing” hides the real mismatch — diff first.
- ! Anything that edits the bundle after signing (a script phase, strip, install_name_tool) invalidates it — sign last.

Remember

“When does it fail? Decode the profile, dump the entitlements, list the identities — diff, regenerate, sign inside-out.”